

Julia Jesionek

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Profile

During my PhD, I study the impact of debt suspension policies on household finance and firm performance. My research focuses on identifying causal effects in microdata to inform macroeconomic models. I work with individual-level data and apply advanced causal inference techniques (*DiD*, *RDD*), combining empirical and theoretical approaches.

Experience

Ph.D. Candidate in Economics (*Ghent University, Belgium*)

09/2023 – present

- Research on debt suspension policies for mortgages and corporate loans:
 - Impact of payment suspension policies on household balance sheets (event study Difference-in-Differences analysis)
 - Heterogeneous firms default model to study the mechanisms of payment suspension and its impact on firms' dynamic decisions

Trainee – Fiscal Policies Division (*European Central Bank, Frankfurt, Germany*)

08/2022 – 07/2023

- Part of the fiscal modeling team developing the semi-structural BASE model for multi-country analysis
- Conducted research on the effects of high inflation on public finances resulting in the *ECB Occasional Paper 332: "The effects of high inflation on public finances in the euro area"*
- Extracted, cleaned, and visualized macro-fiscal datasets for ECB policy presentations

Teaching Assistant (*Namur University, Belgium*)

08/2021 – 07/2022

- Taught Quantitative Methods and Macroeconomics for the Advanced Master program in Economics
- Conducted lab sessions: *Introduction to Matlab* and *Identification of shocks in VAR models (Canova toolbox)*.
- Supervised 4 Master's theses on macroeconomic and financial stability topics.
- Ph.D. courses: *Bayesian VAR* (Prof. Mumtaz), *Big Data in Macro and Finance* (Prof. F. Monti, grade 16/20), *Advanced Topics in International Macroeconomics* (Prof. Y. Onder, grade 18.5/20)

Education

Ghent University

since 09/2023

Ph.D. in Quantitative Macroeconomics (in progress) Ph.D. courses: **Quantitative Methods for Dynamic Economics** (Yasin Kürşat Önder), Machine Learning with Python (Bart Van Rompaye)

Université Catholique de Louvain / Warsaw School of Economics

2019 – 2021

Research Master's in Models and Methods of Quantitative Economics (QEM)

Thesis: **"The impact of financing government spending shocks with labor or consumption taxes in a HANK model"** (grade 18/20)

Ph.D. courses: *Optimal Policy* (Prof. R. Oikonomou)

Publications

[1] **Mortgage Moratoria** (2025), Julia Jesionek, Koen Schoors, Yasin Kürşat Önder and Bulent Guler, *Gentse Economische Inzichten* 22

[2] **The effects of high inflation on public finances in the euro area** (2023), Bańkowski, K., Checherita-Westphal, C., Jesionek, J., & Muggenthaler, P., *ECB Occasional Paper Series* 332 – [link](#)

Working papers

[1] Julia Jesionek, Koen Schoors, Yasin Kürşat Önder and Bulent Guler, Milan van den Huevel, **Mortgage Moratoria as Fiscal-free Stimulus: Evidence from Belgium**

Conferences & Courses

- 2025: 10th Luxembourg Workshop on Household Finance and Consumption (poster); Ghent Empirical Macro Workshop, Gent (poster)
- 2024: Empirical Macro Workshop, Gent (poster)
- 2023: Workshop on Macroeconomics and Survey Data, Brussels (poster)
- 2022: Summer Workshop on Macroeconomics and Finance, Warsaw School of Economics

Scholarships

- Rector’s Scholarship for high academic achievement, Warsaw School of Economics (2016, 2018–2021)
- Finalist, XXIX Economic Knowledge Contest, Poland (2016)

Skills

Software & Programming	MatLab, Python, Fortran, R, Stata
Documentation & Writing	LaTeX, LyX, Overleaf, Typst, Markdown, Quarto
Development Tools	Git, VS Code, Visual Studio
Languages	English (fluent), French (intermediate), Spanish (advanced), Polish (native)